

Budget Narrative

Embodied Compliance Council — AY 2026-2027

Funding Request: \$3,000

Single-year award targeting the RFP's mean award tier. The budget supports the Katz graduate student RA, conference dissemination, and open-access publication fees. Multi-year extension is intended if Year-1 outcomes (ICAIF 2027 acceptance and IEEE banking-paper submission) materialize per the project timeline.

Personnel (\$1,800)

Alex Xiaoyu Ji — Graduate Research Assistant, full-time Katz student
- 8 months part-time (Sept 2026 – April 2027), academic year only (RFP excludes summer salary) - $\$225/\text{month} \times 8 \text{ months} = \$1,800$ - 10% fringe rate already applied per RFP budget template - Role: primary developer of the ECC codebase (council voices, calibration math, WebXR scaffold), corresponding-author co-writer on the ICAIF 2027 paper and IEEE banking-vertical paper

Conference Travel (\$700)

ICAIF 2027 conference (presenter) — bus/train accessible - Two nights hotel (RFP allows up to 2 nights) - Registration fee + transit - Estimated location: northeastern U.S. metro (consistent with prior ICAIF venues)

Publication (\$500)

Open-access fee — ACM or IEEE - One peer-reviewed publication at ICAIF 2027 (trading vertical, calibration discipline as audit primitive) - IEEE banking-vertical paper open-access fee covered through co-author institutional access

where possible; this budget line is reserved for the ICAIF publication and any unforeseen IEEE publication fee not covered through Loredana Levitchi’s institutional channels.

Excluded Expenses (per RFP)

The following are explicitly NOT included in this budget, per RFP guidelines:

- **No general equipment** — Computer hardware (laptops, displays) for Alex and the secondary RA are already available through Katz student resources and personal equipment. No need to purchase.
- **No summer salary** — RA stipend is academic-year only.
- **No PhD or Pathways student stipends** — Excluded student categories per RFP.
- **No full-time employee hires** — RFP excludes permanent positions.

Other Internal or External Funding

No other internal Katz, Provost Research, or external grants have been applied for or received in support of this specific project. The graduate RA’s prior open-source work (council-diff , capstone-orallexa-calibration , embodied-compliance-council repository scaffold) was self-funded and pre-existing as of June 2026.

Future External Funding Pathway

Year-1 outcomes establish the empirical baseline for a planned **NSF AI Institutes program** application (anticipated 2027 cycle) on multi-voice calibration discipline as a primitive for safe agentic AI in regulated domains, with the EU AI Act Article 14 (human oversight) and U.S. ECOA / Reg B (disparate-impact prevention) as the regulatory motivation. The Katz Faculty Research Initiative seed grant directly enables this trajectory.

Budget Summary

Category	Amount
Personnel (1 RA × 8 months, fringe applied)	\$1,800
Conference Travel	\$700
Publication	\$500

Category	Amount
Total	\$3,000